The sensors in your phone

IoT · Level 1 · Lesson 2



Today you will

- Name at least four sensors in a phone and what each is for.
- Explain that a camera is millions of light sensors that make a grid of numbers.
- Measure something with a phone sensor app.

Your phone's sensors

- Motion: turns the screen, counts steps
- Proximity and light: at the top of the screen
- Compass and GPS: direction and place
- Camera: millions of light sensors

Measure with your phone

1. Get a parent's OK; open phyphox or a compass app
2. Choose one thing: light, sound or direction
3. Measure it in two places, three times each
4. Write the number, unit and place every time
5. Compare the places and explain the difference

Ask before installing anything, and use only the official app store. Light readings work on most Android phones, not on iPhones. No phone? The number picture on squared paper teaches the camera's idea just as well.

Let’s discuss

1. Which sensor would you miss most if your phone lost it?
2. Why might two phones give different numbers in the same place?
3. What could the sensors in your phone tell an app about your day?

Check yourself

- Name four phone sensors and one job for each.